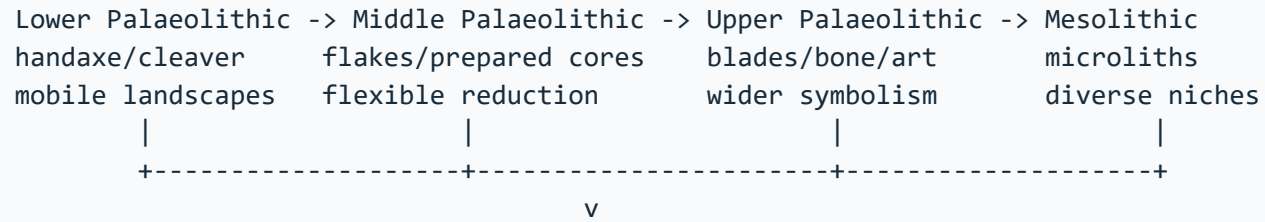


ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/9: Stone Age chronological-climatic spine

PLEISTOCENE

HOLOCENE



Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

RAW-MATERIAL NODULE -> CORE REDUCTION -> FLAKE/BLADE -> TOOL USE -> DISCARD

ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT -> BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/9: Lithic systems compared

LOWER	MIDDLE	UPPER	MESOLITHIC
bifaces, cleavers	flake tools	blades, burins	geometric microliths
large cutting tools	prepared-core planning	bone/ornament growth	hafted composites
quartzite common	raw-material economy	symbolic evidence	bow/sickle/barb uses
+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+
Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.			

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/9: Indian site map: region, site, significance

NORTH WEST: Soan valley -> Acheulian lithics and sequence debates

NORTH: Belan valley -> long prehistoric sequence toward food production

CENTRAL: Bhimbetka -> shelters/rock art | Adamgarh -> Mesolithic evidence

WEST: Bagor -> Mesolithic settlement, subsistence and domestication debate

GANGA PLAIN: Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha, Damdama -> burials and sedentism

SOUTH: Attirampakkam -> early Acheulian and Middle Palaeolithic chronology

DECCAN: Hunsgi-Baichbal -> quarry, factory and landscape organisation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/9: Mobility-subsistence-social loop

SEASONAL RESOURCES → MOVEMENT SCHEDULE → CAMP TYPE → TOOL KIT → SHARING NETWORK

game, fish, plants	base/special camp	hearths	portable/composite
+-----+-----+-----+			

|
v

Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages.
Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/9: Rock art and symbolic life: inference ladder

PIGMENT/ENGRAVING + SUPERIMPOSITION + MOTIF + SHELTER CONTEXT

|

v

secure: image, technique, relative sequence and demonstrated association

probable: hunting, dance, group action, animals and changing style

uncertain: exact myth, deity, artist identity or direct ritual meaning

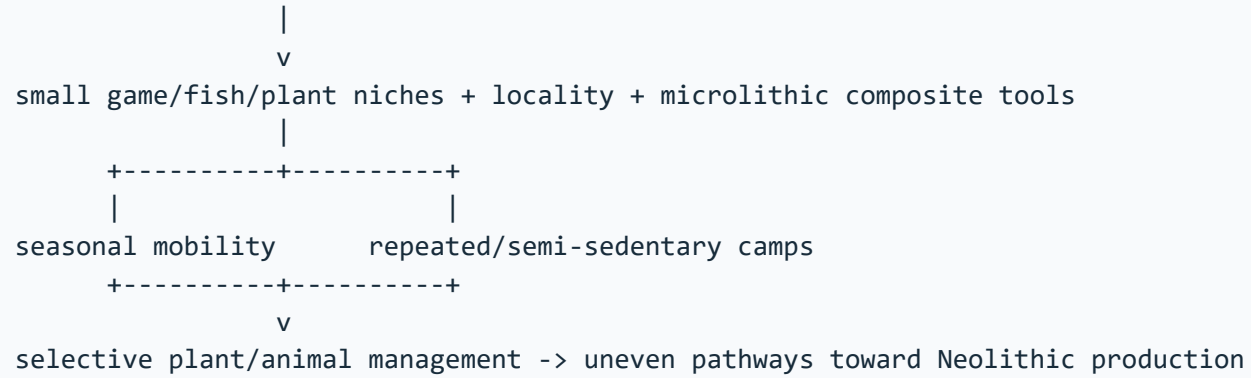
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v

VERDICT: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/9: Mesolithic transition: adaptation, not revolution

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/9: Limits and current research

PROBLEM: sparse fossils + disturbed sites + broad tool labels + uncertain associations

FALSE SHORTCUTS: one tool = one people | innovation = migration | burial = hierarchy

RESPONSE: date contexts, reconstruct reduction sequence, compare regions, state confidence

Refined chronometry and landscape study can revise early dates.

VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/9: Stone Age answer architecture

10 MARKS: define phase -> diagnostic technology -> two sites -> subsistence -> caution

15 MARKS: chronology -> lithic comparison -> ecology/mobility -> symbolic evidence -> limits

20 MARKS: geological frame -> methods -> four-stage technology -> regional site map

-> economy/social life -> Mesolithic transition -> historiographical verdict

MUST DISTINGUISH: relative/absolute date; artefact/assemblage; microlith/sedentism.

CLOSE: technology records adaptive choices, not a uniform evolutionary ladder.